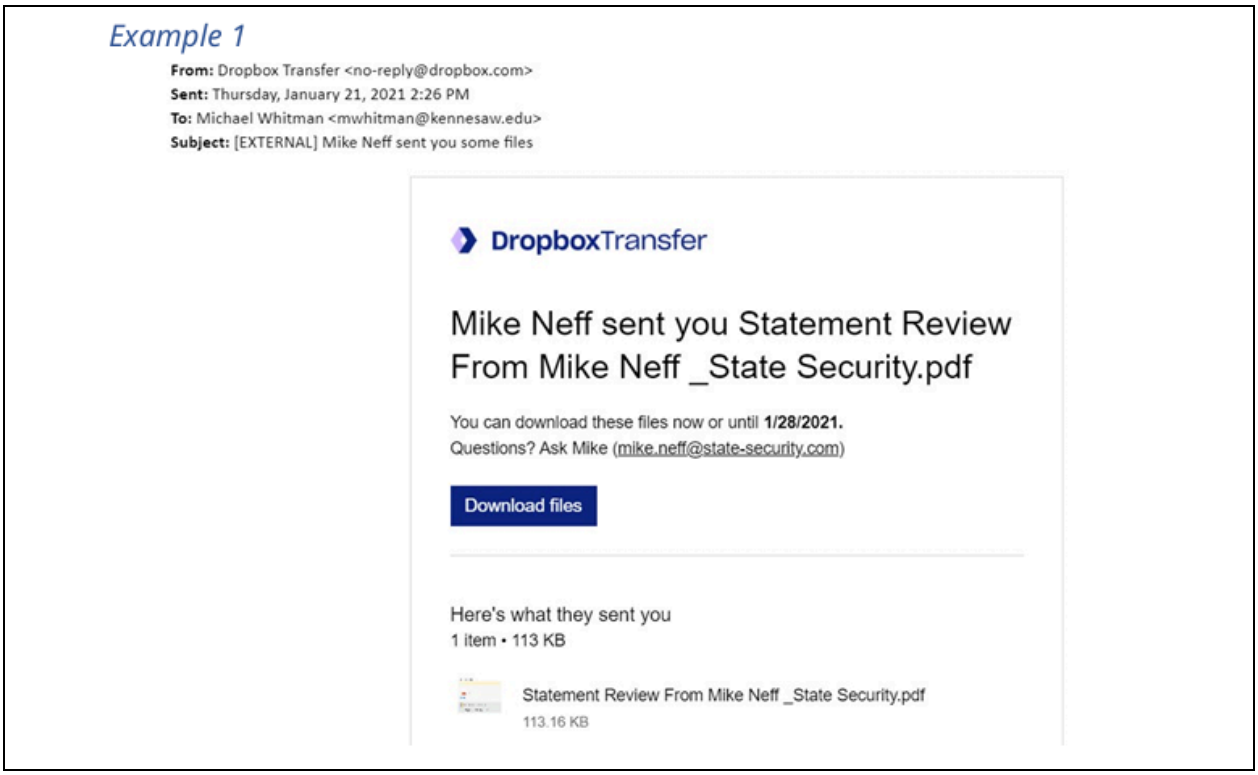
imagine that you are a help-desk analyst reading your organization's abuse e-mail account as co-workers send in suspicious messages. Look at each of the following messages and then determine whether you think they are legitimate or suspicious. Print out the answer page at the end of the lab for recording your answers.

For each suspicious message, explain why you think it fails the "smell test."

Here is a handy list you can use when evaluating each of the following example e-mails:

- The message asks for sensitive information.
- The message does not contain your correct name; other details are incorrect as well.
- The address does not look authentic.
- There are misspelled words and improper grammar.
- The message forces you to a web page.
- The message has an attachment that is not expected.
- Links in the message seem suspicious.
- The message requests that you send money.



Example 1 is **trustworthy**. It shows that Mike Neff sent Micheal Whiteman some files using dropbox. The email came from **no-reply@dropbox.com** which is a legit dropbox domain. No-reply emails are automated and usually used for notification in this case dropbox is notifying Micheal Whiteman that Nike Neff sent him some files. The DropboxTransfer logo is legit.

Example 2

[EXTERNAL] Congratulations you have won

Usa-Lottery <info@kysmaq.co.jp>
Thu 2020-08-06 14:35
To: cinsa@movistar.com.ni

CONGRATULATIONS-COLO.pdf
201 KB

Congratulations you have won the usa mega millions email lottery.attachments below is your winner prize information view the procedures on how to claim your prize

TJDKHDLUSQQJMNMFTOKXIZTYHLJKDLHSBXGIQQ

Example 2 is **suspicious**. The email is about a US lottery winner. The email was sent from Usa-Lottery but the email is info@kysmaq.co.jp which is in japan. .jp is japan. The email body says congratulations you have won, it didnt include the winner's name like congratulation bob, you have won. The grammar is bad, there's no space after the lottery.

The email says:

- Congratulation you have won the usa mega millions email lottery.attachemtns below is your winner price information view the procedures on how to claim your prize

The email includes an attachment called **CONGRATULATION.COLO.pdf** and some random characters at the bottom of the email which is suspicious.

Example 3

Bears Moving Co Booking Confirmation 1-29-21 Herbert Mattord 6 pm Inbox ×

Qualin Ransom <qualinransom@gmail.com> Jan 18, 2021, 6:00 PM (3 days ago) Reply

to me

The scheduled Move agreement is as follows. For $225 we will provide 2-hours of service. We will provide 2-men, all moving equipment (i.e., hand-trucks, pads, dollies, etc). There are no hidden fees (I.e., fuel charges). If the job exceeds the allotted time frame, service charges are as following: $100 per hour beyond the 2-hour minimum. Thanks for booking with us, we look forward to servicing you! Please give us a call for any changes or updates.

***Methods of payment: Cash, Check, Cash App, Venmo (no processing fees).

Credit/Debit (3% processing fee).

Please allow a 1-hour window for arrival.

Example 3 is **trustworthy.** The grammar is good. The email is about a moving schedule agreement Confirmation. The email doesn't ask for money, it's to inform the person about their moving agreement, a Confirmation email. The email is well written. The email subject is: **Bears Moving Co Booking Confirmation 1-29-21 Herbert Mattord 6pm.** This includes the Company Name Date and Client name and Time. The email includes the forms of payments accepted but it doesn't ask the receiver to pay them via email. I'm assuming the recipient will pay the moving company after their service.

Example 4

Vincenz Cruz <lhtcletisjx@outlook.com>
Sun 2018-09-30 12:18
To: [redacted]

drawde is one of your password:) I am Vincenz. I recorded your webcam which shows your immoral sexual actions & video you played on the porno video because that website was infected with my virus. You happen to be appearing eye-catching in the video footage.

The malware then sent all of your email and FB contacts to me.

I'll email your recording to your friends unless you send me 3000 USD via B I T C O I N S in the next 24 hours to the below address:
B I T C O I N Address: 1Fvfp3183h9YgHD6YaoA1nFUCBUgkjGP3w
Make sure to Copy-Paste address because it is CasE SenSiTiVe.

Once money is received by me, I will delete your video and every bit of information I have about you.

Example 4 is **suspicious.** This is an extortion/blackmail email. The email came from Vincenz Cruz and the email is ihtcletisjix@outlook.com. The email is threatening to expose the receiver for watching bad videos if he does not send him $3K via bitcoin. The person also included their bitcoin address.

Example 5

Payment Advice Notification

M

mail_server@company.com
Fri 2020-02-28 13:10
To: infosec

Payment Advice.pdf
8 KB

Dear Customer,

Attached is the Payment Advice that we have processed. The payment date reflects the date at which the payment is processed by our bank. Prior to utilizing the funds, please check with your bank and ensure that the funds have been deposited.

Here is the reference information:
Pay Cycle: SANDLY
Pay Cycle Sequence Number: 1656

This is system generated email, please do not reply.

Example 5 is **suspicious.** The email came from mail_server@company.com. Notification emails are usually sent from no reply emails. The domain name is suspicious. If the email came from an actual bank it would have been sent by something like **no-reply@bankname.com**. The email has an attachment called "**Payment Advice.pdf**". Banks do not send "Payment Advice.pdf". Banks only send pdf if its the users monthly statements or yearly Tax documents and that's only if they have set up email delivery.

Example 6

I SEND THE MONEY TO YOUR NAME SEE PAYMENT COPY IN ATTACH

TB

Theresa Baustert <tbaust@lps.org>
Wed 2011-09-28 19:29

Payment Copy2.html
699 bytes

Payment copy 1.html
1 KB

2 attachments (2 KB) Download all Save all to OneDrive - Kennesaw State University

Please find attached:
I just send the money to your name as ask via western union money transfer.

Regards,
Uzman Shamsi

Example 6 is **suspicious.** The email subject is: **I SEND THE MONEY TO YOUR NAME SEE PAYMENT COPY IN ATTACH.** This subject is very unprofessional. The email has 2 attached files called: **Payment copy 1.html** and **Payment copy 1.html**. One of the attached file sizes is 669 bytes and the other is 1 Kilobyte. The email was sent from Theresa Baustert and her email is tbaust@lps.org. The email says best regards, Uzman Shamsi, which isn't Theresa. The attached files are html file, HTML is used for webpages.

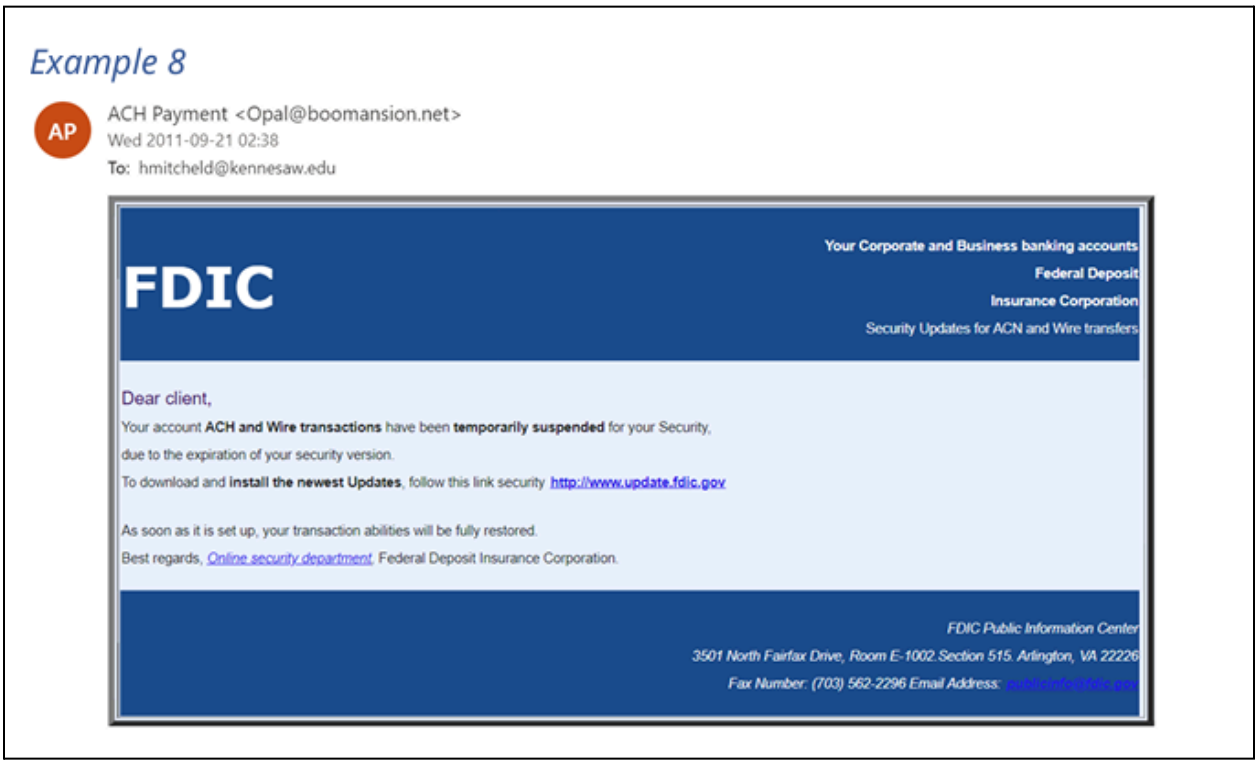
Example 7

Please I Need Ur Help!!

VH Vogelaar, Heleen <Heleen.Vogelaar@uwv.nl>
Sat 2009-06-27 10:16

Dear Friend,
With a very desperate need for assistance.I am Capt. James Micheal. presently in Iraq with the United States Marine Corps;I found your contact particulars in an Address journal.I am seeking your assistance to evacuate the sum of $500,000.00 to you,as far as I can be assured that it
will be safe in your care until I complete my service here.
SOURCE OF MONEY:
some money in various currencies was discovered concealed in barrels with piles of weapons and ammunitions at a location near one of Saddam's old palaces
during a rescue operation,and it was agreed by all party present that the money will be shared amongst us.
The above figure was given to me as my share, There is a secured way of getting the package out to a safer country for you to pick up,and i will discuss this with you when I am sure that you are willing to
assist me, because I do not know for how long we will remain here.
Please you can reach me on my personal e-mail address below for more
information.
Email: capt.james001@sify.com
Thanks
Capt. James Micheal.

Example 7 is **suspicious.** The email subject is "**Please I Need Ur Help!!"**, and it was sent by Vogelaar Heleen and the email is **Heleen.Vogelaar@uwv.nl.** nl stands for netherlands. The email is urgent. The person who wrote the email claims to be Captain James Micheal from the Marine Corps who is currently in Iraq. He wants to send $500K to the receiver. The alleged caption James says in the email that the money is his share after they discovered it in barrels. The alleged caption included his personal email he could be reached at: capt.james001@sify.com



Example 8

AP

ACH Payment <Opal@boomansion.net>
Wed 2011-09-21 02:38
To: hmitcheld@kennesaw.edu

FDIC

Your Corporate and Business banking accounts
Federal Deposit
Insurance Corporation
Security Updates for ACN and Wire transfers

Dear client,
Your account **ACH and Wire transactions** have been **temporarily suspended** for your Security,
due to the expiration of your security version.
To download and **install the newest Updates**, follow this link security http://www.update.fdic.gov

As soon as it is set up, your transaction abilities will be fully restored.
Best regards, *Online security department*, Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation.

FDIC Public Information Center
3501 North Fairfax Drive, Room E-1002 Section 515. Arlington, VA 22226
Fax Number: (703) 562-2296 Email Address:

Example 8 is **suspicious.** The email appears to be from the FDIC ACH Payment but the email came from Opal@boomansion.net. The FDIC is a government agency so the email should have come from a **.gov** email.

This is the email:

Dear client,
Your account ACH and Wire transactions have been temporarily suspended for your Security.

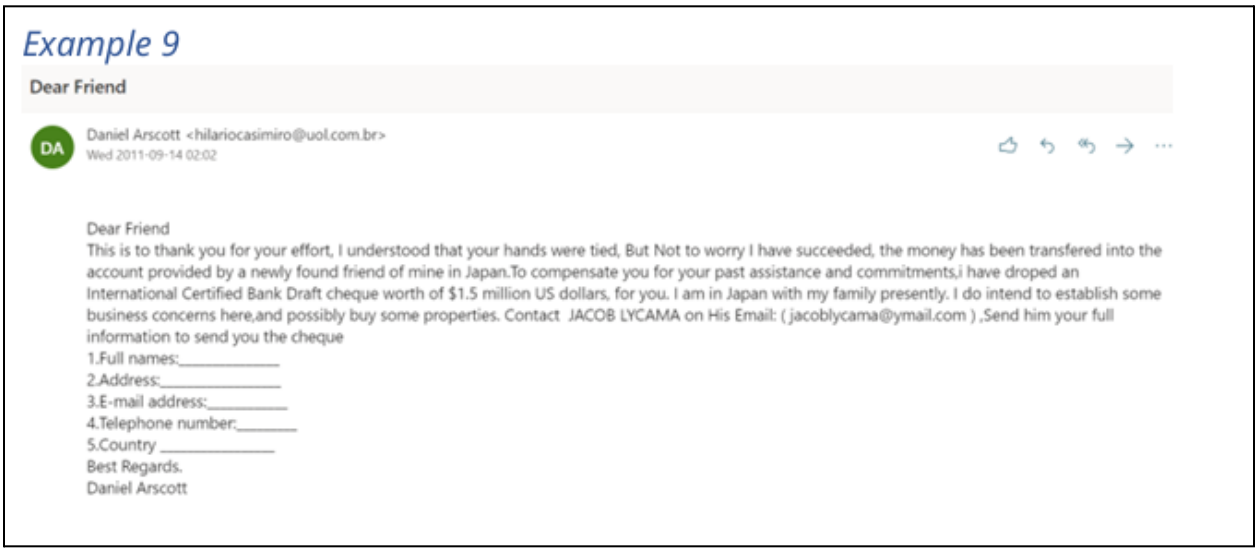
due to the expiration of your security version.

To download and install the newest Updates, follow this link security

http://www.update.fdic.gov

This is an urgent email about an account being temporarily suspended due to the receivers "**security version**" which doesn't make any sense. The email is asking the user to visit a link to download and install updates. The receiver might click the link to learn how to restore their account. The website uses http which is unsecured and the FDIC does not have an update.fdic.gov website. The email says Dear Customer, if the email came from FDIC it would most definitely include the person's real name since it's a government agency they would have

known the user name. The email emphasizes certain word/phrases using bold format example **temporarily suspended**, **ACH and Wire Transactions** and **install the newest Updates**


Example 9

Dear Friend

DA Daniel Arscott <hilariocasimiro@uol.com.br>
Wed 2011-09-14 02:02

Dear Friend
This is to thank you for your effort, I understood that your hands were tied, But Not to worry I have succeeded, the money has been transfered into the account provided by a newly found friend of mine in Japan.To compensate you for your past assistance and commitments,i have droped an International Certified Bank Draft cheque worth of $1.5 million US dollars, for you. I am in Japan with my family presently. I do intend to establish some business concerns here,and possibly buy some properties. Contact JACOB LYCAMA on His Email: (jacoblycama@ymail.com) ,Send him your full information to send you the cheque
1.Full names:_____
2.Address:_____
3.E-mail address:_____
4.Telephone number:_____
5.Country _____
Best Regards.
Daniel Arscott

Example 9 is **suspicious.** The email is asking the receiver for his personal information via email. It's asking for the receiver's Full name, Address, email, phone number and country. The email came from **Daniel Arscott** but the email is hilariocasimiro@uol.com.br. Br is brazil. The email has a lot of typos and mistakes.

This is the email:

Dear Friend
This is to thank you for your effort, I understood that your hands were tied, But Not to worry I have succeeded, the money has been transfered into the
account provided by a newly found friend of mine in Japan.To compensate you for your past assistance and commitments,i have droped an
International Certified Bank Draft cheque worth of $1.5 million US dollars, for you. I am in Japan with my family presently. I do intend to establish some
business concers here,and possibly buy some properties. Contact JACOB LYCAMA on His Email: (jacoblycama@ymail.com),Send him your full
information to send you the cheque

The Alledge Daniel Arscott says he's in japan with his family but his email has .br which is brazil

Example 10

-------- Forwarded Message --------
Subject:AUTO RENEWING EMAIL
Date: Thu, 21 Jan 2021 23:23:27 +0530
From: Norton Official <nortonofficial20@gmail.com>
To:alisaqlain989@gmail.com

NortonLifeLock

AUTO RENEWAL EMAIL

MODE OF PAYMENT	**: CREDIT CARD**
ORDER NUMBER	**: 85692563**
CHARGE	**: $480.87**
HELPLINE NUMBER	**: +1 (570) 260-6102.**

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank You for renewing your Norton Life Lock security for the upcoming one year.

Norton informs you that the contract electronically signed by you with our company for the maintenance of your computer services has expired, and it is auto renewed today for the upcoming year. The transaction of $399.99 would appear within the next 48 working hours on your account.

We would like to inform you that this month we have served over 1 million customers and you are one of them . We hope you will enjoy the services . Due to COVID-19 we are unable to notify each customer through a confirmation call .

If you have any questions or wish to cancel the subscription and get back your refund,

Please contact us on +1 (570) 260-6102.

Thank You,

Team Norton.

(Finance Team)

NOTE: THIS IS AN AUTO GENERATED EMAIL PLEASE DON'T REPLY TO THIS EMAIL.

Example 10 is **suspicious.** The email appears to be from Notron Official and the email is **notronofficial20@gmail.com.** The email does not have the company domain. Email from companies will come from an email with the company domain name.

This the email:

MODE OF PAYMENT : CREDIT CARD
ORDER NUMBER: 85692563
CHARGE: $480.87
HELPLINE NUMBER: +1 (570) 260-6102.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank You for renewing your Norton Life Lock security for the upcoming one year.

Norton informs you that the contract electronically signed by you with our company for the maintenance of your computer services has expired, and it is auto renewed today for the upcoming year. The transaction of $399.99 would appear within the next 48 working hours on your account.

We would like to inform you that this month we have served over 1 million customers and you are one of them . We hope you will enjoy the services . Due to COVID-19 we are unable to notify each customer through a confirmation call.

If you have any questions or wish to cancel the subscription and get back your refund,
Please contact us on +1 (570) 260-6102.

Notification email usually comes from no-reply@companyemail.com. The email includes a number to call for any questions or cancellation. The receiver will be tempted to call this number. If the receiver calls the number the scammer/s will attempt to get their personal information such as Credit Card. The email appears to be urgent because it's about a yearly subscription coming to an end. The email also includes an Order number and payment method and the charge and also a helpline number. The amount is inconsistent, first it says the Charge is **$480.87** and it also says the **transaction of $399.99** would appear within the next 48 working hours on your account. Some people might fall victim to phishing email because it has many details. The email says dear Sir/Madem, it didn't use the person's real name.